PRODUCTS
PEOPLE
TRENDS
CULTURE
MARKETS

TOPIC THEME WE CHOOSE

THE HYPE ECONOMY

"how ordinary products become viral , desirable & premium"

SAME
PRODUCTS.
A DIFFERENT
STORY.

You've Seen Them.

ORDINARY PRODUCTS. EXTRAORDINARY HYPE.



LABUBU



PRIME



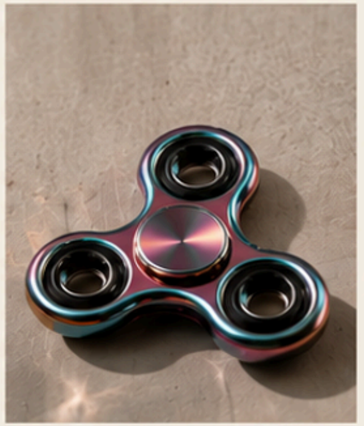
STANLEY



DUBAI CHOCOLATE



CROCS



FIDGET SPINNER

A CASE STUDY IN
VIRAL MARKETING

2026

What Are We ACTUALLY Buying?

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN NEEDS AND OBSESSION.

1. HYDRATION



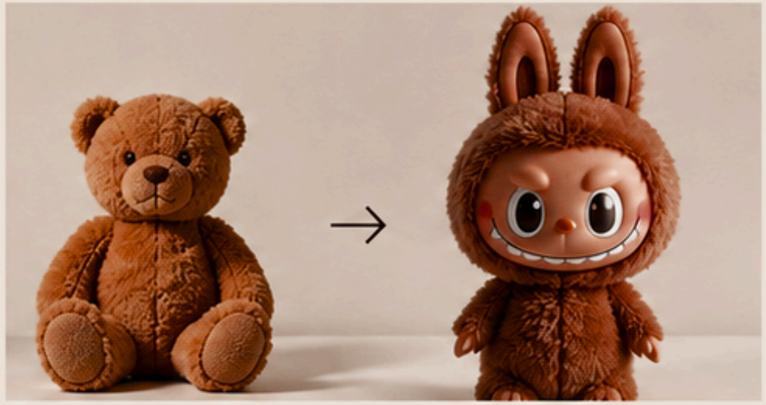
A WATER BOTTLE	STANLEY
₹10 – ₹30	₹3,500 – ₹4,500

UTILITY — Stay hydrated

IDENTITY — Be part of it

DESIRE — Own that one

2. ENTERTAINMENT



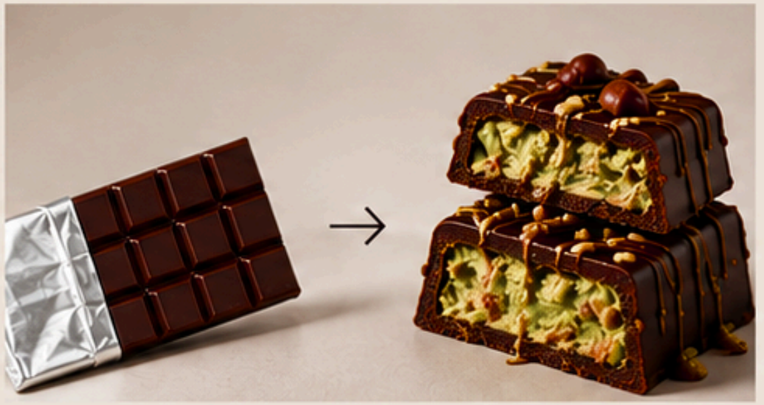
A TOY	LABUBU
₹200 – ₹500	₹4,000 – ₹15,000+

ENJOYMENT — Have fun

SOCIAL PROOF — Be seen

OBSESSION — Hunt the next one

3. INDULGENCE



A CHOCOLATE BAR	DUBAI CHOCOLATE
₹50 – ₹100	₹800 – ₹1,500+

TASTE — Satisfy a craving

VIRALITY — Watch & share

FOMO — I need to try it



LABUBU

HOW DID A ₹4,000 TOY BECOME AN OBSESSION?

A TOY.
A TREND.
A GLOBAL PHENOMENON.

THE LABUBU JOURNEY

2015



CHARACTER BIRTH

Kasing Lung creates Labubu as part of *The Monsters*.

2019



PRODUCT LAUNCH

Pop Mart begins selling Labubu (*collectible blind-box*).

2023



WEARABLE CULTURE

Vinyl-plush pendants make Labubu part of everyday fashion.

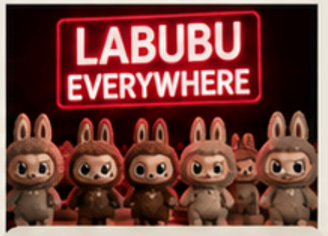
2024



CELEBRITY FUEL

Global visibility with celebrities like BLACKPINK's Lisa.

2025



GLOBAL PHENOMENON

RMB 4.81 *billion* revenue in H1 2025 (34.7% of Pop Mart's revenue).

THE HYPE ENGINE

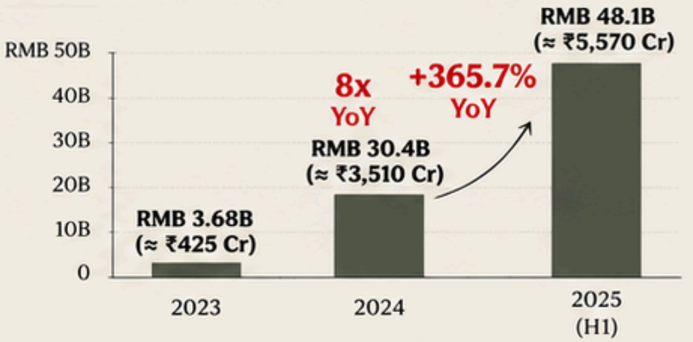
BLIND BOX
You don't know which one you'll get.
CURIOSITY

SCARCITY
Rare and secret variants.
DESIRABILITY

SOCIAL PROOF
Celebrities, unboxings and bag culture.
VIRALITY

REPEAT PURCHASE
Didn't get the one you wanted? Buy again.
HIGHER LTV

THE MONSTERS REVENUE (POP MART)



Labubu didn't sell certainty.
It monetised the chase.

A CHARACTER THAT TURNED CURIOSITY INTO A GLOBAL CRAZE.



STANLEY

HOW DID A ₹2,000 TUMBLER BECOME A CULT ICON?

FROM WORKSITE TO WORLDWIDE.

1913 — ORIGINS



Stanley creates its first vacuum bottle in the USA.

Mid 2010s — LEGACY



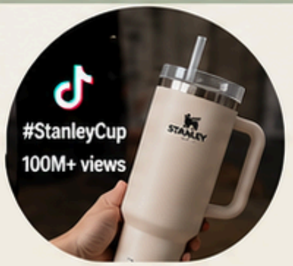
Known for durability among workers, outdoors community and travellers.

2020 — MODERN REDESIGN



The Quencher is launched with a lifestyle-first appeal.

2023 — VIRAL MOMENT



Explodes on TikTok (#StanleyCup) — driven by influencers, aesthetics and lifestyle branding.

2024 — MAINSTREAM



Becomes a global lifestyle product, with frequent sell-outs and new colour drops.

THE HYPE ENGINE

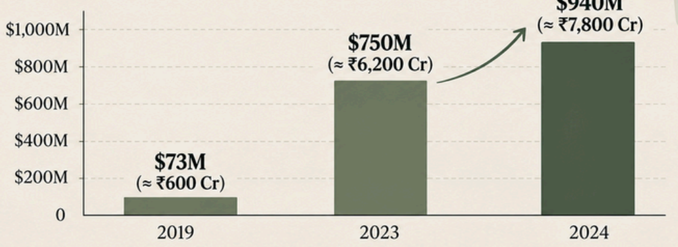
DURABILITY & TRUST
Built to last (vacuum insulation, high quality).
FUNCTIONAL NEED

AESTHETIC APPEAL
Trendy colours, sleek design, fits every lifestyle.
EMOTIONAL WANT

SOCIAL PROOF
TikTok, influencers, celebrities, everyday users.
MASS VISIBILITY

REPEAT PURCHASE
New colours, limited editions, accessories.
CONTINUED HYPE

GLOBAL REVENUE (STANLEY)



~13× growth in 5 years.

EVERYDAY OBJECTS. EXTRAORDINARY STORIES.

Same cup. A global phenomenon.



PRIME

HYPE. HYDRATION. HEADLINES.

HOW DID TWO YOUTUBERS TURN HYDRATION INTO HYPE?

INFLUENCE. SCARCITY. A GLOBAL PHENOMENON.

THE RISE



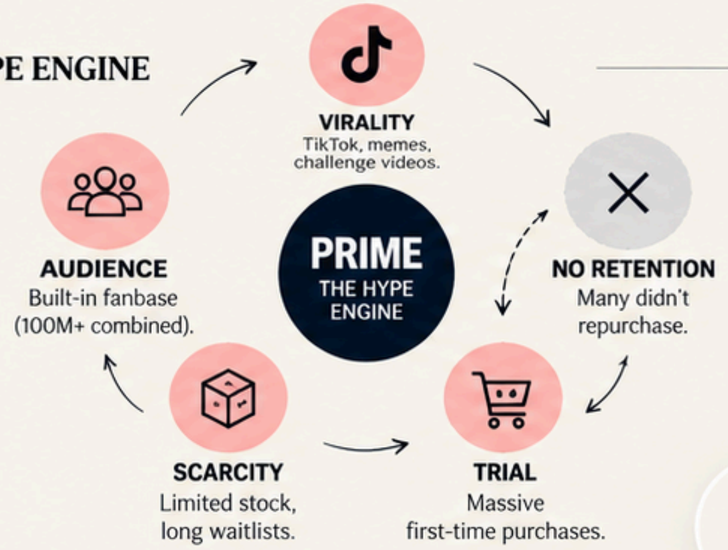
2022
KSI and Logan Paul announce PRIME. Instant massive fanbase.

2023
Explosive launch. Limited stock, huge demand.

2023
Peak virality. TikTok, YooTube and in schools.

2024
Mainstream availability. Hype begins to cool.

THE HYPE ENGINE



WHY THE HYPE BROKE

Novelty faded
Scarcity disappeared as PRIME became widely available.

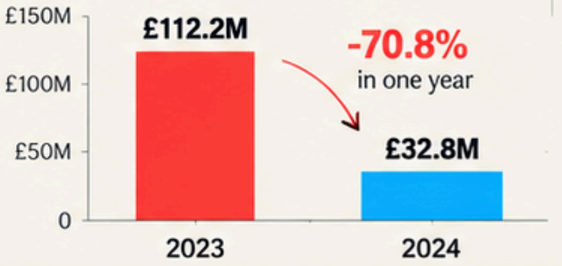
Product didn't build loyalty
Too sweet and artificial for many; not a habitual drink.

KEY REASONS

Controversy and scrutiny
High caffeine in Prime Energy (200 mg per 12 oz), regulatory concerns and media backlash.

Legal and competitive pressure
Lawsuits (e.g. $68M, claim from bottler), trademark disputes and a crowded market.

UK TURNOVER (PRIME HYDRATION)



A sharp 70% decline in the UK, despite global visibility.

HYPE GETS YOU THE FIRST PURCHASE.
THE PRODUCT EARNS THE SECOND.

SAME GAME. DIFFERENT OUTCOME.



COMMON MARKETING STRATEGIES
BEHIND THE HYPE

DIFFERENT PRODUCTS. SAME PLAYBOOK.



REAL WORLD EXAMPLES



LABUBU
Scarcity | Social Proof | FOMO
Blind boxes and viral unboxings created a global craze.



PRIME
Influencers | Virality | Scarcity
Two YouTubers turned a drink into a global phenomenon.



STANLEY
Identity | Community | Collaborations
A functional product became a lifestyle statement.



DUBAI CHOCOLATE
Viral Content | FOMO | Novelty
ASMR and aesthetic content drove massive demand.



CROCS
Collaborations | Identity | Virality
From rejection to cultural icon through smart collabs.



FIDGET SPINNER
Simplicity | Virality | FOMO
A low-cost toy that went global through social media.

THE PSYCHOLOGY BEHIND IT ALL

ATTENTION → INTEREST → DESIRE → TRIAL → RETENTION?

Hype gets them to try it.
Only the product keeps them.



WHEN DOES HYPE BECOME A BRAND?

SAME START. DIFFERENT DESTINATIONS.

VIRAL MOMENT

A product gets attention through a viral story, influencer, or trend.

PEOPLE NOTICE — It shows up everywhere. →

PEOPLE WANT — FOMO kicks in. →

PEOPLE TRY — They make a purchase.

NOW WHAT?

HYPE FADES

When there's no lasting value, the excitement wears off and the product is quickly forgotten.

Novelty only → One-time purchase → No strong community → Trend disappears

EXAMPLES



FIDGET SPINNER — Massive hype, short-lived.



PRIME — Huge initial demand, but declining relevance.

HYPE BECOMES A BRAND

When the product delivers real value, builds a community and keeps evolving, the hype turns into long-term success.

Useful product → Repeat purchase → Identity & community → Innovation & collaborations → Long-term relevance

EXAMPLES



STANLEY — From a utility product to a global lifestyle brand.



CROCS — Cultural icon through collaborations and community.



LABUBU — Still growing — collectibility and community could turn hype into a lasting brand.

HYPE MAKES YOU WANT IT. | VALUE MAKES YOU KEEP CHOOSING IT.

So the next time something goes viral...

ARE YOU BUYING THE VALUE — OR THE HYPE?

Hype today. Value tomorrow.